

FRIDAY

JESUS WELCOMES RICH AND POOR

**MEMORY
VERSE**

The rich and the poor have this in common, the Lord is the maker of them all. **Proverbs 22:2 NKJV**

INTRODUCTION WELCOMING RICH AND POOR

Jesus cared about rich people and poor people because everybody needed to learn about God's love. He knew that poor people could feel discouraged and overwhelmed by their struggle to survive, and rich people could depend on their wealth rather than God. Jesus also knew that there would always be poor people in our communities, because, however much we have, there will be people in greater need.

God's original plan was that wealth would be shared, and richer people would take care of poorer people. He instructed

farmers to leave some grain for poor people to gather. He told a rich young man to sell everything he had and give it to the poor, to test his relationship to his wealth.

Jesus was also concerned that people would show greater respect to wealthy and important people and be disrespectful to those who were poor or seen as less important. Jesus wanted everyone to feel equally loved and respected. He wants us to be generous and share whatever we have with

others, just as He generously made juice for the wedding, fed 5000 people, and generously gave His life in love for every human being.

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Read together
the story of the
encounter of
Zacchaeus and
Jesus:
Luke 19

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Jesus loved making friends with people. He especially liked to be friends with people who felt lonely and unloved. He didn't mind if they were rich or poor! They all needed to know that they were loved and special.

One day Jesus went to Jericho. The crowds were following Him through the streets, and everyone wanted to see Him and be near Him. Zacchaeus lived in Jericho. He was very rich, but he didn't have any friends because he was a tax collector, and because he took more money from the people than he was supposed to take.

Zacchaeus was rich, but sad. He thought no one loved him. He wanted to see Jesus because he had heard about His teachings and he wanted to change his life, but it was too hard to do it on

his own. Maybe Jesus would help...
He tried to find a place to see
Jesus, but he was too short to see
over people's heads, and nobody
wanted to help him because they
thought that he was mean and greedy.

He wanted to help
him feel loved and
help him to change
his life and care for
other people.

kind, generous and honest in his
work. He used his money to help
poor people instead of hurting
them.

Zacchaeus climbed into a tree to see Jesus
secretly, but Jesus knew Zacchaeus. He was
looking for him. He wanted to help him feel
loved and help him to change his life and
care for other people. Jesus looked up and
saw Zacchaeus, and smiled at him and told
him that He wanted to have dinner with him!
Zacchaeus was so happy! He went home and
made a big dinner for Jesus and His friends!
And when he knew how much Jesus loved
him, it changed His life and he decided to be

One day Jesus was in the temple. A
poor widow came to worship God. She loved
God with all her heart, and she was sad that
she only had two tiny coins to put in the
offering. Lots of rich men came to the temple
with bags of gold. Some of them wanted
everyone to see how rich and generous they
were.

The poor widow was embarrassed that she
was so poor. She quickly dropped her two
coins in the money box and hurried away.
She thought that she was poor and invisible,

but Jesus saw her and spoke loudly and clearly so everyone could hear. “I want to tell you something special! This poor widow has given a bigger offering than anyone else! The rich men gave only a little of their great wealth, but she gave everything she had, and that takes courage and faith.”

The poor widow heard Jesus’ words and she was so happy! Jesus had noticed her tiny offering and made it very special! Many poor people who have heard her story have been encouraged. They know that God sees and understands when they can only give a little. God wants poor people and rich people to feel welcome in His kingdom.

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understands
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MEMORY VERSE ACTIVITIES

- Cut out a large paper heart.
- Write the memory verse around the edge of the heart.
- Inside the heart write the names of people you know who are rich and poor and pray for them all.

PRAAYER ACTIVITIES

PRAYING FOR PEOPLE WHO ARE POOR

- Pray for someone you know who is much poorer than you.
- If possible, ask them what they would like you to pray for them. Do something, however small, to bless them in a helpful way.

SMALL COIN PRAYER

- Pass two tiny coins around the family.
- Whoever is holding the coins will pray for someone who is poor and struggling and pray that God will bless your resources as you use them to help others.

PRAYING FOR PEOPLE WHO ARE RICH

- Some rich people have so many things that they don't feel a need to pray or to know God.
- Pray that they will recognize the loneliness and emptiness in their lives and reach out to God.
- Pray for the Christians who are rich, that God will guide them in the wise use of their resources, so that others can be blessed in ways that will improve their lives.

FAMILY ACTIVITIES

BLESSING THE POOR

- Think about the people and families you know who are struggling because they don't have enough money.
- Ask the family about their greatest needs, so that you know how to help them in the best possible way.
- Where possible, give them dignity by letting them make their own choices about food and clothing purchases.
- What can you do as a family to bless a poor family? If you don't have enough to spare, perhaps you could take time to help them with a task, or childcare, instead of giving them money, food, or clothes.

FAMILY FOOD PARCEL

- Start a family food parcel so that you have food to share with others when they have a need.
- Each time you shop for food, purchase at least 1 item of long-life food. Choose a variety of food that is good quality and includes some delicious treats.
- Keep them in a sturdy box so that it is easy to give a food parcel when you find someone who is hungry.

BLESSING THE RICH

- We often forget to bless the rich. They need love and prayers too!
- Choose a person in your community who has been a generous blessing to others, or who is serving wisely and kindly as a leader.
- Make and send them a card of appreciation or write a short prayer of blessing and send it to them.

FRIDAY SNAPSHOT!

THE VERSE

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THE INTRODUCTION

Jesus wanted everyone to feel equally loved and respected. He wants us to be generous and share whatever we have with others.

THE DEVOTIONAL

We know that God sees and understands when we can only give a little. God wants poor people and rich people to feel welcome in His kingdom.

THE PRAYER

Pray to receive the Holy Spirit’s wisdom for the days when resources are scarce, and even more so for when you are blessed with abundance.

THE CONVERSATION

Ask everyone in the family for ideas on how to use the resources God gives you to create a plan to help those in need.